

resentation doesn't depend on the dimensions of the object), though a vector graphic with a small file size is often said to lack detail as compared to an actual photo.

Similarly, one can indefinitely zoom in to the arc of a circle, and it still remains smooth. On the other hand, a polygon representing a curve will reveal that it is not really curved.

On zooming in, lines and curves need not get wider proportionally. Often the width is either not increased or less than proportional. On the other hand, irregular curves represented by simple geometric shapes may be made proportionally wider when zooming in, to keep them looking smooth and not like these geometric shapes.

The object parameters are stored and can be modified later. This means that moving, scaling, rotating or filling doesn't degrade the quality of a drawing. Moreover, it is normal to specify the dimensions in device-independent units, which results in the best possible rasterisation on raster devices.

From a 3-D perspective, rendering shadows is also much more realistic with vector graphics, as shadows can be abstracted into the light rays forming them. This allows for photo realistic images and renderings.

Typical primitive objects

- Lines and polylines
- Polygons
- Circles and ellipses
- Bezier curves
- Bezigons
- Text (in computer fonts such as True Type where each letter is created from Bezier curves)

This list is not complete. There are various types of curves, which are useful in certain applications.